

ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY

PLMB Engineering Investments

Corporate Governance Policy: Controlled Document

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Document Control

Field	Detail
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Approval Authority	Managing Director
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Applies To	All PLMB operations, projects, sites and personnel; see Section 5 (Scope)

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes	Approved By
3	1 September 2026	Third revision of this policy, reissued to align its entity name, Policy Owner and Approval Authority designations and head office details with PLMB Engineering Investments Limited's current Business Profile.	Stainley Bakolo, Managing Director

Related Documents

- Project-specific Environmental and Social Management Plans (ESMPs), where required by a client, funder or contract.
- PLMB Occupational Safety, Health and Welfare procedures.
- PLMB Waste Management and Hazardous Substances registers (site level).
- Contract and subcontract documentation incorporating environmental clauses.

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1. Policy Statement

PLMB Engineering Investments Limited (“PLMB” or “the Company”) recognises that its construction and engineering activities have the potential to affect the environment and the communities in which it operates. The Company is committed to conducting its business in a manner that protects the environment, prevents pollution, uses natural resources responsibly, and complies with all applicable environmental laws, regulations, permits, licences, project conditions and other obligations to which it subscribes.

This Environmental Policy sets out the principles, responsibilities and requirements that govern how PLMB manages its environmental performance across all of its operations, projects and sites. It is designed to remain valid and enforceable throughout the year and across every phase of the business, regardless of season, project size, financial position or changes in management or personnel.

This policy has the full support of PLMB's senior management and applies to everyone working for, or on behalf of, the Company.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Set out PLMB's commitment to environmental protection and sustainable operating practice.
- Provide a consistent framework of principles, responsibilities and procedures for managing environmental risks and impacts across all PLMB activities.
- Ensure compliance with applicable Malawian environmental legislation and relevant contractual and international requirements.
- Provide a basis for monitoring, reporting on, and continually improving PLMB's environmental performance.

3. Objectives

In support of this policy, PLMB shall pursue the following objectives:

- Prevent or minimise pollution arising from Company operations.
- Use water, energy, fuel and materials efficiently and avoid unnecessary wastage.
- Minimise waste generation and promote its avoidance, reduction, reuse and recycling.
- Protect soil, water resources, vegetation, biodiversity and surrounding communities from avoidable environmental harm.
- Maintain compliance with applicable environmental legal and contractual obligations.
- Build organisational capability through induction, training and awareness.
- Continually review and improve environmental performance, controls and management arrangements.

4. Scope

This policy applies, without exception, to:

- PLMB's head office, all construction and project sites, workshops, quarries/borrow pits (where operated by PLMB) and temporary facilities such as site camps;
- all employees, whether permanent, fixed-term or casual;
- all contractors, subcontractors, suppliers and any other person working on behalf of PLMB; and
- all projects, regardless of client, funding source, contract value, size or duration, and at every phase of the project lifecycle, from mobilisation, through construction and operation, to demobilisation and close-out.

This policy applies at all times and in all seasons. It is not suspended or diminished during peak workloads, low-activity periods, financial or operational pressure, emergencies or disruptions, or changes in management or personnel.

Precedence: Where a specific project, contract, client or funder (for example, a project financed by a development partner) imposes environmental requirements that are more stringent than this policy, including through a project-specific Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP), then those requirements shall take precedence on that project, and personnel shall comply with both this policy and the project-specific requirements to the extent they are not inconsistent.

5. Definitions

Term	Definition
Company / PLMB	PLMB Engineering Investments Limited, including its head office, sites, projects and all persons working on its behalf.
Environmental Aspect	An element of PLMB's activities, products or services that can interact with the environment (for example, fuel storage, waste generation or water abstraction).
Environmental Impact	Any change to the environment, whether adverse or beneficial, wholly or partly resulting from PLMB's activities.
Environmental Incident	An unplanned event that has caused, or had the realistic potential to cause, harm to the environment (including a spill, uncontrolled discharge, or non-compliant disposal).
Hazardous Substance / Waste	Any material, substance or waste with properties (chemical, physical or biological) that make it dangerous to human health, safety or the environment.
Competent Person	A person who, through training, qualification or experience, has the knowledge and ability to perform an environmental task correctly and safely.
Corrective Action	Action taken to eliminate the root cause of an identified non-conformity and to prevent its recurrence.
Contractor / Subcontractor	Any third party engaged, directly or indirectly, to carry out works or provide services on behalf of PLMB.
Policy Owner	The role designated by PLMB with day-to-day responsibility for maintaining, communicating and monitoring compliance with this policy (see Section 8).

6. Guiding Principles

PLMB's environmental management is founded on the following principles:

- Legal compliance is a minimum standard, not a target to aspire to.
- Prevention before cure: impacts should be avoided or reduced at source rather than remedied after the fact.
- Proportionality: controls should be proportionate to the environmental risk involved and realistic given PLMB's size and resources.
- Shared responsibility: every person working for, or on behalf of, PLMB shares responsibility for environmental performance.
- Continual improvement: environmental objectives, risks and controls are reviewed periodically and improved over time.
- Transparency and accountability: environmental performance, incidents and corrective actions are recorded and reported honestly.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

Environmental management is a line-management responsibility, supported by a designated environmental focal role. Table 1 sets out the principal responsibilities under this policy; project- or site-specific arrangements may add further detail but shall not reduce these minimum responsibilities.

Role	Key Responsibilities
Managing Director	Approve this policy and material amendments; provide the resources, authority and organisational support needed for its implementation; hold overall accountability for PLMB's environmental performance; approve exceptions under Section 11.2.
Policy Owner (e.g. HSE/Environmental Officer or equivalent focal role)	Day-to-day implementation and communication of this policy; maintain the legal and compliance register; coordinate training; investigate significant incidents; maintain records; liaise with regulators and clients on environmental matters; prepare periodic reports (Section 13).
Project / Contract Managers	Ensure this policy and any project-specific environmental requirements are implemented on their projects; incorporate environmental requirements into site inductions, method statements and subcontract terms; ensure project close-out includes environmental sign-off (Section 8.2.6).
Site Supervisors / Foremen	Day-to-day supervision of waste, water, energy, fuel and materials handling on site; enforce site environmental controls; stop any activity presenting an immediate, significant environmental risk and escalate immediately.
All Employees	Comply with this policy and site-level procedures; use resources responsibly; report environmental incidents, hazards and non-conformities; attend required induction and training.
Contractors, Subcontractors and Suppliers	Comply with this policy and applicable environmental requirements as a condition of engagement; ensure their own personnel are inducted and competent; report incidents to PLMB without delay.
Procurement / Contracts Function	Incorporate environmental compliance clauses into contracts and purchase orders; consider environmental performance when selecting contractors and suppliers where practicable.

8. Policy Requirements and Procedures

This section sets out PLMB's operational requirements. Unless stated as discretionary ("may") or recommended ("should"), all requirements below are mandatory ("shall").

8.1 Legal and Other Compliance Requirements

1. **Legal Register:** PLMB shall identify, maintain and keep up to date a register of environmental laws, regulations, permits, licences, project conditions, contractual requirements and other obligations applicable to its operations, including at minimum:
 - the Environment Management Act, 2017 (Act No. 19 of 2017), administered by the Malawi Environmental Protection Authority (MEPA);
 - the Occupational Safety, Health and Welfare Act, 1997 (Act No. 21 of 1997), so far as it relates to environmental health and welfare on PLMB's sites;
 - subsidiary legislation made under the Environment Management Act relating to waste management and sanitation, and any successor regulations (the Policy Owner shall confirm the current instrument in force at each review, as subsidiary legislation is updated from time to time);
 - applicable local authority by-laws relating to waste, sanitation and land use in the areas where PLMB operates;
 - any environmental standard adopted by PLMB or required by a specific client or funder contract, such as ISO 14001 (Environmental Management Systems), where applicable.
2. **Review of the Register:** The legal and compliance register shall be reviewed at least annually, and whenever a new project, site or type of activity is undertaken, by the Policy Owner.
3. **General Obligation:** PLMB shall also comply with other applicable permits, licences, project conditions, contractual requirements and relevant environmental obligations not listed individually above.

8.2 Waste Management

1. **Waste Hierarchy:** PLMB shall apply the waste hierarchy (avoidance, reduction, reuse, recycling or recovery, and, only as a last resort, safe disposal) as the default order of preference on all sites, throughout the year, irrespective of project phase.
2. **Classification:** Waste shall be classified as general, recyclable/reusable, or hazardous at the point it is generated, using a site waste log maintained by the site supervisor.
3. **Segregation and Storage:** Segregated, clearly labelled storage shall be provided at each site office and principal work area, proportionate to the scale of the site.
4. **Hazardous Waste:** Hazardous waste shall be stored in secure, labelled, weatherproof containers or bunded areas, and shall be handled and disposed of only through authorised waste handlers or facilities. Records of hazardous waste handover shall be retained for a minimum of five (5) years.
5. **Prohibited Practices:** Uncontrolled dumping, open burning of waste, and disposal of waste into drains, watercourses or other water bodies are strictly prohibited on all PLMB sites and by all contractors, without exception.
6. **Project Close-Out:** Final clearance of construction waste, temporary facilities and any residual hazardous materials shall be planned and completed as part of every project close-out or demobilisation plan, and confirmed on the close-out environmental checklist (Section 10.2).

8.3 Water Use and Protection

1. **Monitoring:** Significant water use (for example, bulk water for concrete batching or dust suppression) shall be estimated or metered where practicable, and reviewed periodically to identify unnecessary use and opportunities for improvement.
2. **Efficient Use:** Leaks shall be repaired promptly; employees and project teams shall use water efficiently and avoid unnecessary wastage.
3. **Protection of Water Resources:** Cement, fuel, oils, chemicals, wastewater and other pollutants shall be prevented from entering drains, watercourses, wetlands or groundwater. Concrete washout and refuelling shall take place only in designated, controlled areas.
4. **Drainage, Erosion Control and Reuse:** Appropriate drainage and erosion-control measures shall be installed before or during earthworks, not after problems arise. Rainwater harvesting and water reuse shall be considered at the planning stage of new sites, camps or permanent facilities, where technically and economically practical.
5. **Annual Rainy-Season Preparedness:** Ahead of each rainy season, active sites shall review and, where necessary, reinforce drainage, erosion and sediment controls as a standing annual requirement rather than a one-off measure (see Section 10.2).

8.4 Energy and Fuel Use

1. **Efficient Use:** PLMB shall promote the efficient use of electricity and fuel in offices, sites, vehicles, machinery and equipment.
2. **Maintenance:** Vehicles, machinery and equipment shall be maintained in accordance with manufacturer schedules, with maintenance records retained, to improve efficiency and reduce unnecessary fuel consumption.
3. **Engine Idling:** Unnecessary engine idling shall be avoided; this requirement shall be communicated to drivers and operators through induction.
4. **Renewable Energy:** Renewable energy options, including solar power, shall be considered for new site offices, camps and permanent facilities where technically and economically practical.

8.5 Hazardous Materials Management

1. **Secure Storage:** Fuels, oils, lubricants, paints, chemicals and other hazardous substances shall be stored in designated, secured, and where necessary banded or contained areas, kept away from watercourses and drainage.
2. **Labelling and Handling:** Hazardous substances shall be clearly labelled and handled in accordance with applicable requirements. Safety Data Sheets (or equivalent safety information) shall be available at the point of use, and personnel handling these substances shall be trained.
3. **Spill Prevention and Response:** Sites with a significant spill risk (fuel storage, refuelling points, workshops) shall maintain spill-response equipment appropriate to that risk and a documented spill-response procedure.
4. **Incident Reporting:** All spills shall be reported to the Policy Owner within twenty-four (24) hours of discovery. Significant spills (as identified by the site environmental risk assessment) shall be investigated and closed out with corrective and preventive action.

5. **Disposal:** Contaminated soil, absorbent materials and containers shall be managed as hazardous waste and disposed of in accordance with Section 8.2.

8.6 Pollution, Soil, Vegetation and Biodiversity Protection

1. **Pollution Control:** PLMB shall implement reasonable and proportionate measures to control dust, smoke, emissions, noise, vibration and contaminated runoff, with particular care near residential areas, water sources and other sensitive receptors.
2. **Soil Protection:** Land disturbance shall be limited to the minimum footprint necessary for the works, and erosion and sediment shall be controlled throughout construction.
3. **Vegetation and Biodiversity:** Unnecessary vegetation clearing, wildlife disturbance and damage to habitats shall be avoided; where clearing is unavoidable, it shall be limited to the approved project footprint.
4. **Site Restoration:** Disturbed areas shall be progressively restored in line with project specifications or environmental requirements, and shall not be left unrestored at project close-out without documented justification recorded by the Project Manager.

8.7 Environmental Training, Awareness and Competence

1. **Induction:** All employees, contractors and subcontractors shall receive environmental awareness training as part of site induction before commencing work.
2. **Toolbox Talks:** Toolbox talks covering relevant environmental topics shall be conducted on active construction sites at a minimum frequency set out in the site environmental plan (recommended: monthly).
3. **Task-Specific Training:** Personnel performing tasks with significant environmental risk (for example, hazardous substance handling or spill response) shall receive task-specific training before undertaking that task unsupervised.
4. **Training Records:** Training and induction records shall be maintained for each site and employee and retained in accordance with Section 14.

9. Governance and Controls

9.1 Delegation and Approval Authorities

Table 2 sets out the minimum approval authorities for key environmental decisions. Project-specific delegations of authority may be more restrictive but shall not be wider than set out here without approval from the Managing Director.

Decision / Action	Approval Authority
Approval of this policy and any material amendment	Managing Director
Minor or editorial amendment (no change of substance)	Policy Owner, notified to the Managing Director
Approval of project-specific Environmental and Social Management Plans	Project/Contract Manager, reviewed by the Policy Owner

Decision / Action	Approval Authority
Authorisation of hazardous waste disposal arrangements or contracts	Policy Owner / Procurement Function, within approved budget
Approval of an exception or temporary deviation from a mandatory requirement of this policy	Managing Director (see Section 11.2)
Approval of environmental-related capital expenditure or budget	Managing Director, in accordance with PLMB's standard financial approval limits

9.2 Integration with Project Management Systems

Where a project or contract requires a documented Environmental and Social Management Plan, framework or equivalent, that document shall be prepared consistently with this policy. On that specific project, the project document shall govern in the event of any conflict, provided it does not fall below the minimum standards set out in this policy.

9.3 Resourcing

PLMB shall provide the resources, competence and organisational structure reasonably necessary to implement this policy, proportionate to the size and risk profile of its operations at any given time, including during periods of financial or operational pressure. A reduction in available resources does not suspend the mandatory requirements of this policy; where resourcing constraints genuinely prevent compliance, the matter shall be escalated under Section 11.2 (Exceptions and Escalation).

10. Risk Management

10.1 Environmental Risk Assessment

A basic environmental risk assessment shall be completed for each project or site prior to mobilisation, and shall be reviewed whenever site conditions, scope of work, or season change materially, including at the onset of the annual rainy season and at project close-out.

10.2 Risk and Control Summary

Activity / Aspect	Typical Risk	Key Control(s)	Responsible
Earthworks / land clearing	Erosion, sedimentation, habitat loss	Minimise footprint; phased clearing; erosion and sediment controls	Site Supervisor
Concrete works and washout	Soil and water contamination	Designated washout areas; containment	Site Supervisor
Fuel and chemical storage	Spills, contamination	Bunding; secure storage; spill kits	Policy Owner
Waste generation	Uncontrolled dumping or burning	Segregation; authorised disposal; site waste log	Site Supervisor
Dust, emissions and noise	Nuisance or health impact on nearby communities	Dust suppression; working-hours controls; equipment maintenance	Project Manager

Activity / Aspect	Typical Risk	Key Control(s)	Responsible
Water abstraction and use	Resource depletion, wastage	Monitoring; leak repair; reuse	Project Manager
Annual rainy season	Flooding, erosion, mobilisation of stored contaminants	Pre-season inspection and reinforcement of controls (Section 8.3.5)	Policy Owner
Project close-out	Residual contamination, unrestored land, abandoned waste	Close-out environmental checklist and restoration sign-off	Project Manager

10.3 Continuity During Disruption and Management Change

The environmental controls in this policy (including hazardous storage security, spill response and waste containment) shall be maintained during emergencies, operational disruptions, and periods of reduced staffing. Whenever the person holding the Policy Owner role changes, responsibilities shall be formally handed over in writing to the incoming role-holder, and the Managing Director shall be notified, so that oversight is not interrupted.

11. Compliance and Exceptions

11.1 Compliance Requirements

Requirement Category	Source	Verification Method	Frequency
Legal and regulatory compliance	Environment Management Act, 2017 and subsidiary legislation; Occupational Safety, Health and Welfare Act, 1997; applicable local authority by-laws	Legal register review; site inspection	Annually / at each review
Contractual and client requirements	Project-specific ESMPs, funder or client environmental conditions	Contract file review; ESMP compliance check	Per project milestone
Internal policy requirements	This policy and associated site procedures	Site inspection checklist; training records	Monthly (active sites)
Voluntary / adopted standards	ISO 14001, where adopted by PLMB or required by contract	Internal review against standard requirements	Annually, where applicable

11.2 Exceptions and Escalation

- 1. Requesting an Exception:** Any request to deviate from a mandatory (“shall”) requirement of this policy shall be submitted in writing by the requesting Project or Site Manager to the Policy Owner, and shall be approved by the Managing Director before the deviation takes effect.
- 2. Emergency Action:** Where immediate action is genuinely necessary to protect life, property or the environment, personnel may act without prior approval, but shall report the action to the Policy Owner within twenty-four (24) hours for retrospective review.
- 3. Limits on Exceptions:** Exceptions shall be time-bound and documented, and shall not be used to permanently waive a legal requirement or a client/funder condition.

12. Monitoring, Reporting and Performance Measurement

12.1 Monitoring and Inspection

Routine environmental inspections shall be conducted on active sites using a standard checklist, at a minimum monthly frequency, or more frequently where site risk assessment indicates this is necessary.

12.2 Reporting Requirements

Report	Frequency	Prepared By	Submitted To
Site environmental inspection checklist	Monthly (active sites)	Site Supervisor	Policy Owner
Environmental incident or spill report	Within 24 hours of the incident	Person identifying the incident, consolidated by the Policy Owner	Project Manager; Managing Director (significant incidents)
Waste, water and energy summary	Quarterly	Policy Owner	Managing Director
Environmental performance summary	Annually	Policy Owner	Managing Director
Legal and compliance register review	Annually	Policy Owner	Managing Director

12.3 Performance Indicators

PLMB shall track a small number of practical indicators appropriate to its size and resources, which may include: the number and severity of environmental incidents and spills; hazardous waste volumes disposed of through authorised handlers; environmental training completion rates; the proportion of corrective actions closed within the agreed timeframe; and the results of site inspections. Indicators shall be reviewed periodically by the Policy Owner and may be adjusted as PLMB's operations evolve.

13. Records and Documentation

PLMB shall maintain the following records for a minimum of five (5) years, or such longer period as required by law or contract:

- the legal and other compliance register;
- environmental risk assessments and site inspection records;
- training and induction records;
- waste transfer or handover records and hazardous waste manifests;
- incident, spill and corrective action reports;
- records of exceptions granted under Section 11.2; and
- this policy and its version history.

Records shall be stored securely, in physical and/or electronic form, and shall be retrievable for audit, regulatory or client review. Loss or destruction of a record other than at the end of its retention period shall itself be recorded and reported as a non-conformity under Section 14.

14. Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

1. **Consequences of Non-Compliance:** Any employee who fails to comply with this policy or an applicable environmental legal requirement may be subject to corrective action, which may include retraining or disciplinary action up to and including termination, in accordance with PLMB's disciplinary procedures. Any contractor or subcontractor in breach may be required to take corrective action, and may have its works suspended or its contract terminated, in accordance with the terms of its engagement.
2. **Recording and Investigation:** All identified non-conformities shall be recorded and investigated to a degree proportionate to their significance, and shall be closed out with corrective and, where relevant, preventive action within an agreed timeframe.
3. **Escalation:** Repeated or serious non-compliance shall be escalated to the Managing Director without delay.

15. Review and Amendment

1. **Scheduled Review:** This policy shall be formally reviewed at least every two (2) years from its Approval Date.
2. **Trigger for Earlier Review:** An earlier review shall be triggered by: a change in applicable law or regulation; a significant environmental incident; a material change in PLMB's operations, structure or risk profile; findings from an audit or a client/funder review; or a change in the person holding the Policy Owner role.
3. **Amendment Process:** Proposed amendments shall be reviewed by the Policy Owner and approved in accordance with the delegation of authority set out in Section 9.1.
4. **Continuity:** This policy remains in full effect, without interruption for reasons of season, financial year, project phase or management change, until formally reviewed, amended or withdrawn in writing by the Managing Director.

16. Effective Date and Transitional Arrangements

This policy takes effect on 1 September 2026 and supersedes all previous versions of the PLMB Environmental Policy, whether formally documented or applied informally. Where an active project was mobilised under a previous version of this policy, the project team shall transition to the requirements of this version within ninety (90) days of the Effective Date, except where an existing project-specific ESMP or contractual requirement already meets or exceeds the standard set out here, in which case the existing arrangement may continue until its next scheduled review.

17. Conclusion

At PLMB Engineering Investments, environmental protection is a core part of how the Company conducts its construction and engineering business, not an optional add-on. Through the consistent application of this policy and its supporting procedures, PLMB will work to minimise its environmental footprint, protect natural

resources and surrounding communities, meet its compliance obligations, and contribute to sustainable development in Malawi.

All employees, contractors, subcontractors and other persons working on behalf of PLMB are expected to support and comply with this policy.

18. Approval

This policy shall be effective from the date shown below and remains valid until superseded in accordance with Section 15.

Role	Name / Position	Date
Prepared by	Harios Kandoje and Simbarashe Beatrice Mtambo, Environment Health and Safety Officers	1 September 2026
Reviewed by	Victor Chabwera, Managing Partner and Contracts Director	1 September 2026
Approved by	Stainley Bakolo Position: Managing Director	1 September 2026

Signature:



Review period: every two (2) years from the Approval Date, or earlier as required under Section 15.